

SURROUNDED BY 700 BODIES, ENVELOPED IN ONE LAKH WATTS OF PULSATING MUSIC, THE GROUND QUAKING 6.1 ON THE RICHTER SCALE THEY SWIRL AROUND, AS MUCH THE WATCHER AS THE WATCHED

PARTY ON: At night in Elevate

NIGHT LIFE IN A METRO

Noida | Uttar Pradesh



Club class

■ By Gaurav Rajkhora

This is the new India, with bulging wallets, slick new cellphones and an unquenchable thirst to party hard. And this is their new Eden, a night club that promises them a moveable cocktail of dance and DJ music.

At the entrance to Elevate, one of the country's hippest nightspots, the air is charged with a clamorous anticipation, as if some grand nocturnal pagan ritual is about to begin. The line crawls, and breaks into an archipelago of little islands of restless conversations.

It's a long wait, long enough for one to ponder over the absurdity of it all—a young generation flush with quick money, blowing up Rs 1,500 on over a night of dancing at the country's coolest address. Walking down, one sees the new urban India that likes to party. Back pockets stuffed with bulging wallets, the slickest new cell phone models flashing like blades in the dark, and bling tattooed all over the body. "People flock here because Elevate is a clubbing experience that gives them their

money's worth," says Ranvir Tuli, the club's corporate head of operations.

Get elevated, their promotional tagline says. But out there, it's like drowning in a well of sound, surrounded by 700 surging bodies, enveloped in one lakh watts of pulsating music, the ground beneath quaking—being a Bodysonic dance floor, and arrayed above another two levels of swirling, swaying people. Elevate is tailor-made for a generation for which fun is not enough. Only 'big' fun will do. On the main dance floor are the adrenaline junkies, those who spell party as 'd-a-n-c-e'. On this level, the DJ on the elevated console, often a celebrity mixer, reigns supreme. Higher than that is the terrace lounge. Thirty-two feet above the ground, this is the best place to wind up a night of sheer madness, sipping the final drink, watching Delhi's amber skyline lightening to the purple grey of dawn.

SHAN TANKHA